

REVEAL SCENE - Dialogue

Draft v3

Setting: courtyard below Mount Fuji, at the END OF LEVEL 2 (after both levels' worth of trials are complete — 5 total across Level 1 and 2).
Player has handed the real items to the princes along the way (off-screen or in a short handoff beat per trial). Princes now present them to Kaguya as their own.

PART ONE: The Princes' Lie

PRINCE ISHITSUKURI:

The Buddha's own begging bowl. I crossed three provinces for it.

PRINCE KURAMOCHI:

The jeweled branch of Mount Hōrai, cut by my own hand.

MINISTER ABE:

The robe of the fire rat. The flames themselves could

not take it from me.

MINISTER ŌTOMO:

The dragon's jewel, pried loose in a storm I barely survived.

LORD ISONOKAMI:

The swallow's shell. It nearly cost me my life to bring it here.

KAGUYA:

(quiet, studying each item — then looking past them, to the player)

These are real. Every one of them. That much I don't doubt.

ŌTOMO:

Then the trials are complete. Choose.

KAGUYA:

I said the treasures were real. I said nothing about the hands that found them.

(she turns to the player)

You were seen at the temple. At the mountain. At the shore. Five times, in five places these men claim as their own labor.

ISHITSUKURI:

(too quickly)

A servant. Sent ahead to carry—

KAGUYA:

Carrying is not finding. And you were not there to send anyone,
because you were not there at all.

KURAMOCHI:

This is beneath a princess's dignity, to take a commoner's word over—

KAGUYA:

It isn't his word I'm taking. It's the truth sitting in your hands,
which none of you can explain the first thing about.

ABE:

(the robe, still smoldering slightly from an earlier test)
Princess, be reasonable—

KAGUYA:

I have been endlessly reasonable. Five times over. I'm finished being
reasonable with men who let someone else bleed for their honor.

ŌTOMO:

(drawing himself up, temper snapping)
Then honor will settle it instead.

(Ōtomo draws first; the others fall in behind him, cornered)

KAGUYA (to player, aside):

I'm sorry. You did the honest part. Let me help you finish it.

**[BOSS GAUNTLET: Ōtomo (Krampus) → Ishitsukuri
→ Kuramochi → Abe →
Isonokami]**

PART TWO: NegaKasey's Theft

(princes defeated, items now gathered and held by Kaguya; player approaches to finally receive her thanks / the ending beat)

KAGUYA:

You did what five grown men could not. Come — these treasures are yours to—

(a shadow falls across the courtyard; the items are yanked from her hands by an unseen force before she can finish the sentence)

NEGAKASEY:

(mocking, mirror-image sneer)

Hers to give? No. Mine to take. You did all the work — I'll take all the credit. Feels familiar, doesn't it?

KAGUYA:

(shaken, but not cowed)

Who are you—

NEGAKASEY:

(already fading back into shadow)

Someone who's been waiting for the two of you to finish the easy part.

(NegaKasey vanishes with the treasures)

KAGUYA:

(to player, steadying herself)

I don't know what that was. But I know where the moon's light still reaches, and it isn't here.

(she raises a hand; moonlight gathers and folds the courtyard away)

KAGUYA:

Hold on to me. Wherever he's gone, I'm not letting you chase him alone.

[KAGUYA TRANSPORTS THE PLAYER TO LEVEL 3 - NegaKasey established as true final villain]

Notes for implementation

- Both parts of this scene now happen back-to-back at the END of Level 2
— the princes' gauntlet and NegaKasey's theft are one continuous sequence, not split across levels.
- Part One keeps the emotional beat on the princes lying about *effort*, not the items themselves — Kaguya's line "I said the treasures were real" front-loads the twist so it doesn't feel like a rug-pull later.
- Ōtomo drawing first still sets up Krampus as the gauntlet's opener.
- NegaKasey's reveal is a hard cut with no foreshadowing dialogue, since this is his first appearance — his line now plays as a fresh threat rather than referencing history that doesn't exist yet.
- Kaguya transports the player to Level 3 herself via a moonlight effect, and explicitly comes along rather than staying behind — gives her a reason to be present for whatever NegaKasey-focused content Level 3 needs.